

B5

Environmental Regulations

This diagram outlines the environmental strategy of the project through the use of locally sourced basalt stone from New York as the primary cladding system. The facade integrates basalt tiles across a modular panel assembly, grounding the building in its regional material context while reducing transportation impact and embodied energy.

Rather than applying a generic envelope, the system uses basalt as a site-specific skin, linking the building directly to the geological identity of Manhattan. The material operates as both finish and environmental mediator, contributing to thermal mass, durability, and long-term performance.

By sourcing basalt locally, accounting for roughly **70 percent** of the building's skin material, the project significantly reduces transportation-related emissions and overall embodied carbon. This becomes critical at the scale of a large civic building, where material volume has a direct environmental impact. The strategy leverages proximity as a design tool, lowering the project's carbon footprint while maintaining architectural intent.

